

24.2 The Kingdom of Jerusalem

Meanwhile Richard, who (like Philip) had traveled by sea, had been shipwrecked on Cyprus. He had paused to capture the island from its Greek governor and did not arrive at Acre until early June.

His fleet—twenty-five ships, laden with men and provisions—heaved to on the horizon like the Second Coming, and the Crusaders welcomed him as the savior of the Crusade. "All the people were in transports," the *Itinerarium Regis Ricardi* tells us, "shouting out congratulations and blowing trumpets . . . and there was great joy because the desire of all nations had come. . . . Nor was it easy to find any one who did not share in the general joy and welcome."[12]

Philip was one. The hero's welcome put him into an extremely poor temper, not sweetened by Richard's refusal to hand over half of Cyprus. (The Crusade, in Richard's eyes, hadn't started until he got to the Holy Land, so Cyprus was his personal conquest.)* Philip had also been suffering from various fevers, rashes, and stomach ailments ever since his arrival. He was sick of crusade, sick of Richard, sick of Acre. Communication between the two kings broke down so thoroughly that, at one point, Philip was negotiating Acre's surrender on one side of the city while Richard was attacking it on the other.[13]

Finally, the garrison at Acre—with Saladin's approval—agreed to a truce. The soldiers would surrender the city, their lives would be spared, and in return Saladin would release all of the prisoners he still held, pay a substantial sum over to the Crusader war effort, and also return the fragment of the True